GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

October 31st, 2025
Week 44
Volume 277, Issue 1209

Highlights:

- **Stultifying.**
- **Few sales.**
- **Listed woes.**
- **Trade warming.**
- **Harrowing 2025.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"Someone's sitting in the shade today because someone planted a tree a long time ago."

– Warren Buffet

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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HALLOWEEN NOVEMBER?

A spooky end to October delivered its share of unending surprises not only across the ship recycling arena, but even global markets at large. At the onset, Trump wraps up his Southeast Asian glamour tour touting deals made, especially one with China where an embargo on retaliatory trade sanctions and set offs between the two nations was set for at least a year, bringing a sigh of relief to embattled vessels enroute to discharge in Chinese waters and even global consumers at large. With September inflationary numbers on the rise and U.S. figures being released only a couple of weeks back (due to the ongoing government shutdown), November seems on track to deliver another set of surprises for ship recycling markets. Oil meanwhile slipped nearly 1% during the week as it lingered around USD 60.67, with OPEC+ announcing further cutbacks in the supply of oil in upcoming Q1 2026 (adieu 2025), leaving lingering expectations of increasing gas prices.

Supply side was no different as the Baltic Exchange's Dry Index also reported a noteworthy fall as the overall index fell nearly 1.3% for the week (on the back of all sub-segments reporting losses), down nearly 8% for the month of October and further marking its first monthly decline since April 2025. And this slowdown is increasingly presenting itself via tonnages of various sizes and types across the Indian sub-continent ship recycling landscape, especially in India where despite the lowest prices in the region, Alang continues to report an eye-popping number of occasional arrivals. And yet, the glut of tonnage sailing the high seas remains disproportionately ratioed against the number of units recycled over the last several years, leaving a potential surge of incoming tonnage on the horizon.

As a result, the ship recycling industry has continued to endure a stultifying and sluggish Q4 (in line with the numerous quarters spanning the last few years) with declines evident across all sectors and sales (barring the occasional stunners) occurring at ever deteriorating levels. An eye-catching duo of LNGs sold last week (as a clear-out from this beleaguered sector continues) were just such a highlight, including a seemingly steady trickle of older dissolute handymax sized bulk carriers sold in recent weeks as well (as confirmed by the various port reports). Sales of sanctioned vessels have also shaken the industry with fixtures being reported at well below market pricing into a dithering Alang, establishing a two-tiered price system that is causing confusion and consternation in the industry.

Overall, despite a reported end to the U.S.-Chinese trade tit-for-tat, the constant volatility and ever-changing headline decisions on tariffs and sanctions are now being treated with assured suspicion and careful wariness by international businesses and MNCs. As such, the final months of the year will wind up another haunting 202X for recycling locations, marked by declining levels, starved supply, regulatory red tape, HKC troubles, immovable recycled product, political unrest, tariffs, oil sanctions, and a whole lot more. Someone call Hollywood and make a movie already.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 44 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

FAILING TO IGNITE!

Active on sales.

Several sales to hungry Chattogram ship recyclers seemed have to sparked the market this week. Yet, it really is a very few select end buyers who have been on the hunt for units and that too at surprisingly decent levels (when compared to prevailing local offerings), in order to keep their emptying yards active, and L/C & bank limits satisfied. But the overall trajectory and sentiments have been unchanged for the most part as prices have otherwise been on a downward flight over the last few months, primarily due to recycled ship's steel failing to shift from local recycling yards due to a festering demand as domestic steel mills reportedly continue to outsource raw material.

Price gauge.

And while this has clearly stalled local resales and left prices of recycled steel stranded - including a deliberation in maintaining resale prices on part of ship recyclers so as not to lose their collective shirts amidst the ongoing decline – finally saw steel levels slip USD 3/ton this week and end it at USD 529.50/Ton. The U.S. Dollar was even less unforgiving as it slipped another 45 basis points and ended the week at a healthily worrying BDT 122.37.

Coupled with the crippling uncertainties of the political and economic directions of the country under the current regime, domestic businesses remain on edge even though upcoming elections scheduled for February 2026 could potentially repave renewed economic pathways for the nation. Marginally increasing inflation in September and the possibility of another increase through October also leaves little for the local ship recycling fraternity (and the industry at large) to remain optimistic about either.

Encouraging HKC.

On the plus side, HKC progress and issuance of accreditations continues at pace with a few more yards set to get confirmed by the end of the year, taking the total number of HKC certified ship recycling facilities in the country to 21 – encouraging given that there were only a handful of HKC approved facilities at the start of the year!

Prompt deals.

For now, if you're coming in from the Far East, be sure to check with your favorite Cash Buyer on pricing and good / prompt deals.

MARKET SALES REPORTED

VESSEL NAME	TYPE	LDT	REPORTED PRICE
MONICA P	Bulker	7,779	USD 380/LT LDT ('as is' Belawan)

INDIA

LITTLE HOPE!

The title reads just as the reader would interpret it i.e. based on your use case. But in India's case under the present circumstances, it delivers a sign of hope despite being the lowest placed sub-continent ship recycling destination - and too by some distance.

Diwali downer.

Accordingly, although on the one hand, there has been little in Alang to encourage or excite ship owners and cash buyers holding previously acquired expensive inventory, on the other hand, the present also offers hope to those ship owners and cash buyers who are more in agreement with prevailing market conditions and are ready to accept the lowest recycling levels of the moment, in exchange of a far more secure re-delivery that is devoid of theatrics, despite the rolling state of market fundamentals and sentiments (subject of course all MoA terms being aligned).

Cheap dumping.

And rolling fundamentals are certainly the sign of the times with Indian steel plate prices putting on quite the show of movement, yet ending up where they began at the start of the week. The U.S. Dollar and Indian Rupee divorce has also hit peak momentum as the Rupee lost a massive 1.25% this week, wrapping it up at Rs. 88.70 and striking ever harder that at the foundations that have been keeping local levels precariously balanced during this financial earthquake. Worse yet, post-September pre-November monsoon thunderstorms seem far from over just yet as Trump further threatens Putin with additional economic retaliations should the Ukrainian aggression not curtail – the beneficiary of which has been the Indian market of late.

Steel decline.

Moreover, a great part of the problem has been a two-tiered market that has emerged, due to the dumping of cheap sanctioned tonnage (OFAC and EU / UK listed vessels) that have been concluded at prices well below market levels, thereby collapsing collective local expectations of where offer levels on conventional tonnage should stand at the bidding tables. And local port positions highlight just how far tonnage inflow continues to confound as most are missing the fact these are likely underpriced units with no valid destination to arrive, with India being the only sub-continent market willing / able to accept these dark / shadow ships – but to what end?

Bite?

Overall, even though inflation has dropped far below the Reserve Bank of India's 2% (stable) level and currently at 1.54%, there is clearly room for cheaper financial instruments and loans for ship recyclers. Question remains, how many will bite?

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

IMPORTS IRE!

Steel worries.

Whilst not quite as negative as a price-inert India at present, Pakistan has endured its own flavor of hurdles this year and even this week, with the ongoing dumping of cheap Iranian steel causing a reversal in vessel pricing even though local steel plate prices reman well above the entire industry and a whopping USD +230/Ton above those currently from India, local buyers have been unable to fully exploit the potential of such wide margins. Yet, recent odd maneuvers of readjusting local offerings in order to align themselves with India is more business as usual for the Gadani Gang, who have miraculously managed to retain 1st place on the market rankings for a healthy portion of the year – with nothing to show for it.

Yards must upgrade.

Similar to Bangladesh, both markets have seen a scattering of incoming tonnage over time and although Bangladeshi buyers' revel in the afterglow of geographically suited tonnage with no other competition on that side of the seaways, Pakistani recyclers have to compete with India, which is proving to be a double-edged sword for this market. Moreover, despite having the highest offers at the bidding tables, local recyclers cannot escape the fact that nearly 4 months after the HKC coming into force, the focus to align all HKC yard upgrades towards fruition remains amiss as not a single yards is HKC certified yet (2026?).

No go low LDT.

This is causing consternation for those owners and cash buyers who are considering options on a non-India only re-delivery. The cost of considering? Problems upon delivery as both local recyclers and authorities aren't entirely grounded on the new format of arrival procedures and are thereby facing hiccups. Case and point, the single straggler at anchorage that's been there since late September despite mediocre arrivals deliveries ongoing into his market – including this week.

Notwithstanding, provisional DASR certificates have at least ensured some of the incoming tonnage is going through its share of evaluation and safer recycling practices. But how long will this continue with plate prices flatlining and the PKR itself hitting 283.17 against the U.S. Dollar while Iranian steel pulls the rug from underneath local steel plate prices. It seems as though until HKC accreditations come firmly into play, this destination will likely fester at the top spot in isolation. And not because they are able to offer the highest, but because competing markets continue to slide.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

SUPPLY PINCH!

As the utter lack of supply continues to hammer Aliaga for several years now thanks to the red tape of bureaucracy and coupled with a near absence of Turkey-only market tonnage for nearly 4 years now, it wasn't unexpected to see local recyclers raise their offers in order to tempt owners who may only be in the deliberation stages of recycling their units at this time.

4 years.

But fundamentals remain far from their side as although local steel plate prices have made marginal improvements, the TRY (ending the week at 42.06 against the U.S.$) has done more damage to keep local business operating at usual speeds.

And while inflation (at a whopping +33%) may have countered some of the resale potential of recycled ship's steel, it's a matter of time until Turkey's government makes appropriate fiscal changes to balance the cost of living, while simultaneously squeezing the pace of the domestic ship recycling sector, especially as lending rates remain unattainable for tier-B (and below) recyclers.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 44 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	260 / LDT	270 / LDT	280 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *Oscar the Grouch from Sesame Steet was originally orange instead of green. In the show's first season, Oscar was orange partly due to some limitations of colorized TV at the time. It wasn't until season 2 that he turned green.*
- *If you ever wondered where the term "honeymoon" came from, it originated in the Middle Ages. When there was a newly married couple, they'd be supplied enough honey wine to last the first month of their marriage.*
- *Due to increased blood flow to the fingertips, human fingernails grow faster during summertime.*
- *Illinois is known as the pumpkin capital of the United States.*
- *A housefly's feet are 10 million times more sensitive than a human tongue.*
- *California experiences over 100,000 earthquakes a year. Thankfully, though, many of them are minor or are barely felt at all!*
- *Every year, Norway gifts London a huge Christmas tree, which is then decorated and displayed in Trafalgar Square. The tree serves as a thank-you gift for all the help the UK gave Norway during WWII.*
- *Owls sometimes swallow their food whole.*
- *The average Swiss person consumes about 48 pounds of cheese per year.*
- *Walt Disney made it a rule for Disneyland not to sell chewing gum to keep the park clean.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No holidays in November	November 04 – November 11 November 18 – November 25

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No holidays in November	November 04 – November 07 November 18 – November 21

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
November 09 – Iqbal Day	**No holidays in November**

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ALANG - Port Position as of October 29, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
2	*Impala*	*4,177*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered October 28*
3	Masal	23,159	Oil Tanker	Arrived October 29
4	Neer 1	22,977	Oil Tanker	Arrived October 17
5	***Nirvana***	***9,623***	***Oil Tanker***	***Delivered October 20***
6	*Rimba Empat*	*3,193*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered October 28*
7	*Vertex*	*1,087*	*Oil tanker*	*Delivered October 15*
8	*Yi Chang 6 (Under Tow)*	*1,541*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered October 24*
Total Tonnage		**85,759**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of October 31, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ang	2,631	Barge	Arrived October 28
2	Ang Ho	494	Pusher Tug	Arrived October 28
3	**DK 03**	**7,809**	**Bulk Carrier**	**Arrived August 04**
		10,933		

GADANI - Port Position as of October 29, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Asmaa Z	7,078	Bulk Carrier	Arrived October 28
2	**Eena 1**	**1,444**	**General Cargo**	**Arrived September 27**
Total Tonnage		**8,522**		

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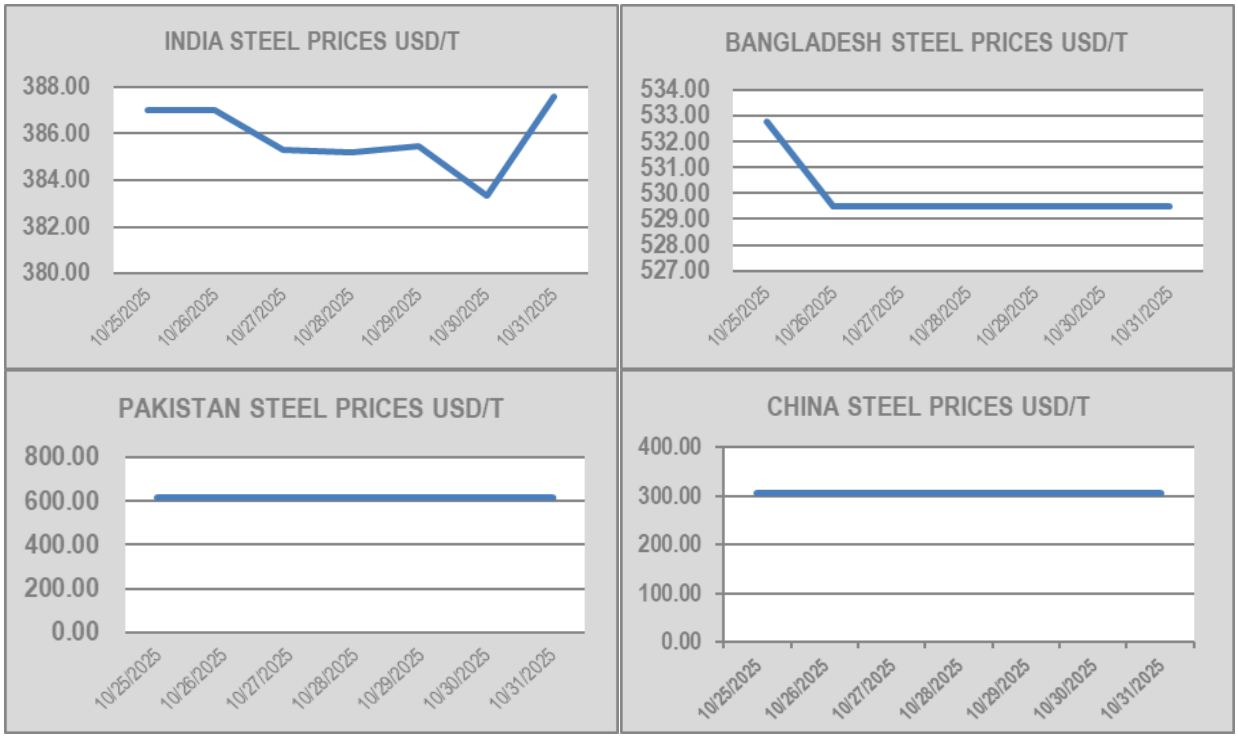
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
10/25/2025	387.02	34,000.00	614.46	173,000.00	532.78	64,600.00	306.48
10/26/2025	387.02	34,000.00	614.46	173,000.00	529.48	64,200.00	306.48
10/27/2025	385.31	34,000.00	614.46	173,000.00	529.48	64,200.00	306.48
10/28/2025	385.23	34,000.00	614.46	173,000.00	529.48	64,200.00	306.48
10/29/2025	385.49	34,000.00	614.46	173,000.00	529.48	64,200.00	306.48
10/30/2025	383.31	34,000.00	614.46	173,000.00	529.48	64,200.00	306.48
10/31/2025	387.61	34,400.00	614.46	173,000.00	529.48	64,200.00	306.48



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